



Colour-Coded, Not Calmer

A Survey of Reset-Chart Completion and Household Dispute Rates in the First Week of Term

Iben Chikere · Petra Umbile — School of Emergent Priorities

The problem

Parenting programs send school-holiday households home with a fridge “reset chart” to tick off before term begins. Completion is easy to check. Whether it changes anything a family actually lives through the first week back is not.

Aims

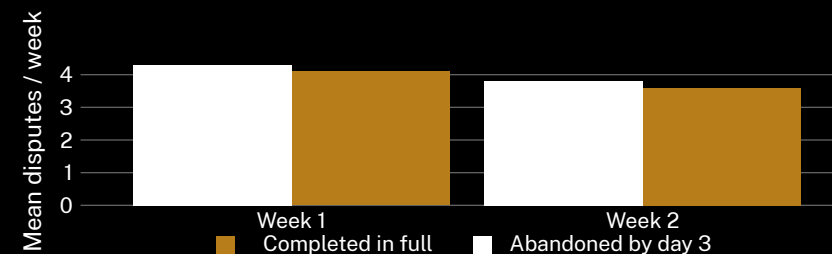
- Test whether chart completion predicts fewer week-one bedtime and screen-time disputes
- Compare parent self-report against an independent shared-calendar dispute log
- Establish whether the chart is a behaviour instrument or a fridge display

Study design

- 214 households · three primary-school parent networks · self-report survey · a fortnight either side of term restart
- binary predictor: chart fully ticked vs abandoned by day 3 of the break
- outcome cross-checked against a 58-household subset’s shared family-calendar entries

Findings

Households completing the chart in full logged 4.1 disputes in week one against 4.3 for those who abandoned it ($p = 0.61$). Completion tracked fridge sticker density ($r = 0.71$) rather than the week it was meant to smooth.



Mean weekly disputes held near-identical across completion groups in both post-term weeks ($n = 214$; $p = 0.61$) — a gap chart completion doesn’t explain.

What it means

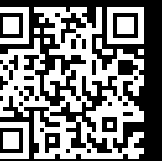
A fully ticked chart correlated with a more decorated fridge, not a quieter Monday. The instrument rewards its own completion. Next: test a chart built around a consequence, not a sticker count.

Selected references

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Parent self-report only; no minors surveyed directly; fridge photographs consented and de-identified.

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“The fridge got busier. The house didn’t get quieter.”

Reset-chart completion tracked fridge sticker density, not week-one dispute counts ($n = 214$ households).